

The Fall Edit — Centrepiece

The evening palette. · **\$95+** · about 22–28 stems



The shop photograph — what the customer is buying.

PALETTE

Burgundy, antique rose, chocolate, plum

The evening palette. Swatches are indicative, not measured — buy to the words and the photograph.

Burgundy

Antique rose

Chocolate

Plum

VESSEL & MECHANICS

Low bowl, 7–8” — it has to be seen over at a table.

If the vessel is unglazed stone or concrete it is porous — it weeps and marks a table. Drop a plain plastic or glass liner inside and put the water and the wire in that, or use a glazed vessel and skip the problem.

STEMS

What goes in, and when you can get it

STEM	QTY	AVAILABLE
Dahlias	4	J F M A M J J A S O N D Midsummer to first frost. Peak in September.
Garden Roses	3	J F M A M J J A S O N D
Chocolate Cosmos	3	J F M A M J J A S O N D Summer into autumn.
Scabiosa	5	J F M A M J J A S O N D Summer into autumn.
Clematis	4	J F M A M J J A S O N D Summer.

Check the calendar before you promise this one. Dahlias, Chocolate Cosmos, Scabiosa, Clematis have a limited season — the strip above shows when. Outside those months, substitute on palette rather than on name: the customer bought a colour and a feeling, not a botanical list.

SOURCING

Where to order

YOUR WHOLESALER

The right call for a Statement, or any week with three or more arrangements. Box minimums make it wasteful for a single order — check the cutoff, it is usually the morning before.

FARMSTAND / FARMERS MARKET

Dahlias, seasonal branches, anything with real character. July to first frost this is the best floral buying in New Jersey, and cheaper than wholesale.

TRADER JOE'S

Reliable for roses, lisianthus and eucalyptus. Buy on colour, not on label, and walk past anything clear or bright if the palette is a muted one.

WHOLE FOODS / RETAIL FLORIST

The gap-filler. More expensive per stem but worth it for the one thing that makes the piece — and a retail florist will sell you single stems.

BUILD

Order of work

1 Condition

Cut on an angle, strip below the waterline, two hours minimum in cool water in the dark. Longer if it travels.

2 Mechanics

Low bowl, 7–8" — it has to be seen over at a table.

3 Foliage sets the silhouette

Establish the shape and the one long line before any flower goes in. The asymmetry is decided here.

4 Focal flowers

Asymmetric cluster, varied heights, faces turned differently. Never a dome.

5 Secondary, recessed

Slightly deeper than the focals. This is where depth comes from.

6 Accents last, riding high

Above the mass on their own stems. Resist tucking them in.

7 Texture into the gaps

Fill the negative space without closing it. Stop earlier than feels finished.

No two arrangements are identical — the studio says so publicly, and it is true. This sheet is the target, not a specification. Match the palette and the scale and the customer has what they paid for. · DreamersJoy Floral Studio